Smart Labels

Introduction

Customers with Smart Records automatically get the Smart Labels functionality. Smart Records previously had options to bulk apply Retention Labels to documents. Smart Labels adds full label management as well.

Retention labels are a great piece of OOTB functionality that can ensure files are retained for a minimum period and protected from ad-hoc deletion by users. Unfortunately, there are also a couple of design flaws with the OOTB approach:

- There are very few options for setting default labels, particularly a default for a particular location. What options there are available are limited to users with E5 licenses.
- Users can set and change the labels applied in the frontend, effectively ignoring any legal or regulatory requirements. It's not possible to hide the label column from users.

Smart Labels is designed to overcome these limitations in a way that covers all sorts of different scenarios.

From that point Smart Labels uses three new columns to control the value of the OOTB **Retention Label** (aka Apply Label) column:

1. Set Label
2. Override Label
3. SR Override – additional column for Smart Records customers

Logic used to set Label

The following logic is used to set **Retention Label** (aka Apply Label) based on these label columns and their values:

- If **SR Override** column exists and has a value
    - If value = 'None' clear any existing label and exit
    - If value matches a label that has been published to the site:
        - Set **Apply Label** = **SR Override**
- Else if **Override Label** column exists and has a value
    - If value = 'None' clear any existing label and exit
    - If value matches a label that has been published to the site:
        - **Set Apply Label** = **Override Label**
- Else if **Set Label** column exists and has a value
    - If value = 'None' clear any existing label and exit
    - If value matches a label that has been published to the site:
        - Set **Apply Label** = **Set Label**

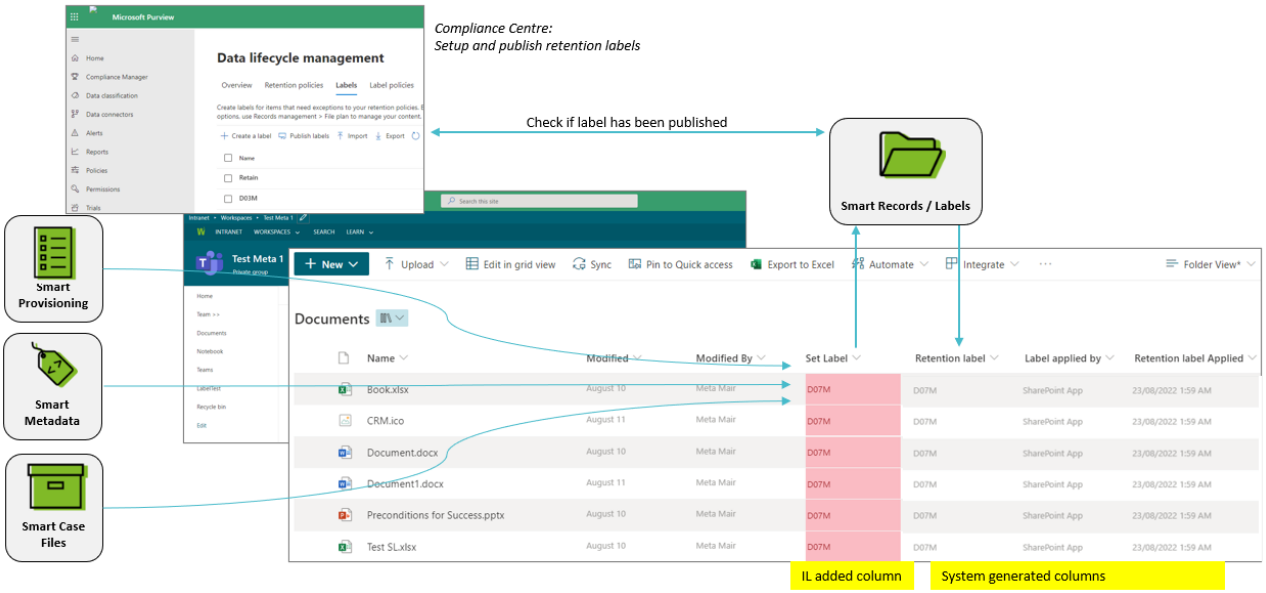
Smart Labels Engine

The Smart Labels functionality has been built into the Smart Records engine, so each time the index process runs the Smart Label logic is automatically applied to any new or edited files and the label updated if necessary.

Using Smart Labels

How it works

The diagram below illustrates how Smart Labels works:



- The Set label column is the primary focus for Smart Labels. It must be populated with a valid label value.
- The value in Set Label column can be set by default or the various iWorkplace tools.
- Overnight Smart Labels will copy the value to the system generated Retention label column, unless avalue has been set in the **Override Label** column or the **SR Override** column.
- The labels will only be copied if they have been setup and published in Microsoft Purview.

Preparation

To prepare to apply Smart Labels you must have setup the labels in Microsoft Purview > Data lifecycle management. The steps to create each label is as follows:

- Create a new label and name it (using the label naming convention) – see next session for more info on naming.
- Choose the “Retain items forever or for a specified period” in the Label settings.
- Select the appropriate retention period, select custom if the time period you require is not listed.
- Select what the retention period should be based on (when should the clock start) – either “when last modified” or “when items were labelled”.
- Review and create the label
- At this stage do NOT publish the label.

Label naming

To prevent mistakes a simple naming convention for labels is suggested:

D03M = Destroy 3 years after last Modified

D07L – Destroy 7 years after label applied

T10M – Transfer to Archive 10 years after last modified

RETAIN – Retain until an event has occurred

Pragmatic label setup

Some disposal authorities require many labels to be setup, often these have time frames that are close together. A more pragmatic view is to standardize on a smaller subset. The retention will then be extended to the next longest. The suggested label setup is as follows:

Destroy labels	Retention / Archive labels
D01L D03M D03L D07M D07L D10M D10L 00 (no retain / delete)	RETAIN T10M NOT SET (default value)

The “NOT SET” label is recommended as the default value for all libraries. This should be setup like the RETAIN label, ensuring the records are protected from permanent deletion, but ensuring it’s clear that no official label has been applied yet.